



“The only way to do great work is to love what you do.”

Steve Jobs, cofounder Apple Inc., 2005

Your weaknesses

Identify aspects about yourself that could hinder the business. These might include:

- › **Inexperience**, in areas such as setting up IT systems, hiring staff, and managing accounts.
- › **Lack of knowledge** in areas such as using social media and software packages.
- › **Personal traits** can include a lack of confidence, disorganization, and impulsiveness.
- › **Personal circumstances**, such as the need to care for children or living in a remote location.

Your interests

Think about what interests you and how you might incorporate this into your business.

- › **What do** you enjoy doing in your spare time?
- › **What sort** of people do you like spending time with, other than your family?
- › **Have you gained** particular skills and knowledge through your interests and hobbies?
- › **What issues** are you most passionate about?

Why now?

Timing is essential in business, and offering the right product at the right time can set you on the path to success. As such, spend time researching your potential market (see pp.20–21), look at what rivals are doing, and seek professional advice. The timing also has to be right for you, of course, but are you ready?

Starting a business requires time and money and also involves pressure and risk, which you need to be prepared for. Unless you are fully confident, look for ways to start selling slowly and gauge demand. If you are currently employed, consider starting the business in your spare time as a side hustle (see p.13), perhaps reducing your employed hours as the business grows.



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Hard skills** are formally acquired indicators of ability, such as a qualification or certificate.
- › **Soft skills** are personal abilities that have developed naturally, such as creative thinking and problem-solving.
- › **Transferable skills** are the capabilities and areas of expertise that can be easily transferred from one role to another. Examples include time management, communication, and leadership.

